

Apple AirPods Pro 3

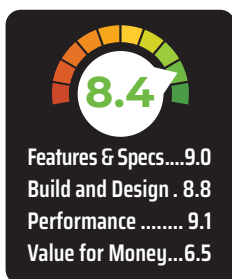
When Great becomes Greater

If the iPhone is Apple's crown jewel, the AirPods are its quiet empire, the one product that redefined how we consume sound without ever asking for attention. It's funny how Apple keeps making the AirPods look like they've barely changed, and yet somehow, they always end up feeling like something new. The AirPods Pro 3 continue that tradition, familiar at first glance, but a quiet evolution once you live with them. Apple's latest Pro earbuds aren't just about music anymore; they want to be your hearing aid, translator, and workout companion, all tucked inside a glossy white pebble of a case. But the real question is simpler: do they still feel as magical as the first time you tried AirPods?

DESIGN & FIT

Apple didn't touch the design much, the AirPods Pro 3 look identical to their predecessor. The same glossy stem, the same bulb-like body, still the kind that tends to collect micro-scratches faster than you'd like. But the magic is in the small refinements. The earbuds sit a bit deeper now, and the slightly smaller bulb means they're less likely to slip out when you're walking or talking. For once, people with smaller ears can finally wear AirPods without worrying they'll pop out halfway through a call.

Apple's new foam-infused silicone ear tips deserve some credit here. They're soft, adaptive, and come in five sizes, including a new XXS. They do a better job at sealing than the old silicone ones, though they're not perfect. Even though they have been upgraded to an IP57 rating, sweat or oil build-up still makes them loosen over time. It's one of those classic Apple "half solutions", innovative on paper, but not a miracle.



SOUND QUALITY

The AirPods Pro 3 sound exactly how you'd expect them to, clean, balanced, and refined, but there's more muscle underneath that polish now. Apple's tweaked the acoustic chamber and fine-tuned its custom drivers to deliver

noticeably better low-end response and cleaner separation.

There's a new sense of control in the bass which is tighter, more deliberate and the mids sit beautifully balanced without feeling overly forward. Instruments sit apart without feeling artificial. It's not the widest soundstage you'll find in wireless earbuds, but for something this small, it's impressively cinematic.

Apple has clearly re-tuned the drivers this time. Where the Pro 2 leaned slightly warm with a hint of mid-bass bloom, the Pro 3 deliver a cleaner, more balanced signature, tighter lows, airier highs, and a newfound sense of space.

Spatial Audio remains divisive. I love it for films and series, where Dolby Atmos mixes truly breathe, but I still find it unnatural for music. Though when you're watching something like

Dune: Part Two at 2 AM with the world asleep, it's hard not to be impressed by how immersive the presentation is.

ACTIVE NOISE CANCELLATION

Apple claims the AirPods Pro 3 have twice the ANC performance of their predecessor. Hyperbole aside, they're not wrong, it's an enormous leap. The AirPods Pro 3 block out more frequencies across the board, from low rumbles to sharp chatter. I tested them on a morning metro ride to Connaught Place. The metallic clatter and station announcements melted away the moment I hit play. The low drone of the train vanished, replaced by the steady pulse of The Weeknd's Blinding Lights. At one point, I removed a bud mid-song, and the noise hit me like a physical wave. That's how good the cancellation is. In a cafe, the ANC neutralised conversations so well that it felt like sitting in a private cocoon.

Transparency Mode is also more natural now. It's uncanny how well Apple has tuned it to sound like you're not wearing earbuds at all. Voices come through clear, without shouting or the electronic hiss that older models had.

SMART FEATURES

Apple's added a heart rate sensor inside each earbud and it's surprisingly accurate. During my morning walks, the readings matched my Apple Watch nearly beat for beat. But once you start lifting or sweating heavily, the buds begin to slip, and the sensor loses contact. Without ear hooks or fins, this was inevitable. It's cool tech, but it's not a replacement for something like the Beats Powerbeats Pro 2. For now, it feels more like a "nice-to-have" than a must-have.

Then there's Live Translation, Apple's bold attempt to break the language barrier. It works decently in quiet spaces but stumbles in real-world chaos. It's a bit limited in terms of understanding different languages and feels more like a proof of concept than a travel companion.